# Cheng Chen

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## Education

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**Tongji University**, Shanghai, China Sept. 2023 – Present
**B.Eng. in Electrical Engineering**, College of Electronic and Information Engineering
Major Rank: **3/87** | CET-6: **519**

## Publications

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- Yi Xu, **Cheng Chen**, Wenzhuo Lei.
  If You Hear It, Help Find It: Orthogonal Knowledge Distillation for Open-Vocabulary Audio-Visual Event Localization
  ***ACM MM 2026*** (Accepted; Oral).
- **Cheng Chen**, Yi Xu, Mufan Cao.
  OrthKD: Extracting Generalized Clinical Knowledge from Heterogeneous Teachers for Lightweight Deployment
  ***IJCAI 2026*** (Accepted; Oral).
- **Cheng Chen**, et al.
  Neural-Operator Risk Assessment for Deployable Risk Triage
  ***NeurIPS 2026*** (Under Review).

## Research Experiences

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**If You Hear It, Help Find It: Orthogonal Knowledge Distillation for Open-Vocabulary Audio-Visual Event Localization**
Accepted at **ACM MM 2026**

- Addressed the difficulty of open-vocabulary audio-visual event localization, where heterogeneous audio and visual teachers provide uneven supervision and naive distillation propagates modality-specific errors.
- Proposed **OvOrthKD**, extending orthogonal feature distillation to audio-visual learning so complementary cross-modal cues are preserved while unreliable teacher signals are suppressed.
- Built a lightweight open-vocabulary localization pipeline accepted as an **oral** presentation at ACM Multimedia 2026.

**OrthKD: Extracting Generalized Clinical Knowledge from Heterogeneous Teachers for Lightweight Deployment**
Accepted at **IJCAI 2026**

- Addressed expertise asymmetry in multi-teacher distillation for diabetic retinopathy screening, where a weaker ViT teacher (**0.83 QWK**) harms students under standard logit fusion with a stronger CNN teacher (**0.88 QWK**).
- Proposed **OrthKD**, distilling only complementary feature-level context from the weak teacher while enforcing orthogonality between teacher projections to avoid redundant knowledge transfer.
- Evaluated on **132,049** retinal images; the **5.4M**-parameter MobileNetV3 student reached **0.885 QWK** on EyePACS and improved zero-shot Messidor-2 performance from **0.507** to **0.728 QWK** (**+22.1** percentage points).

**Neural-Operator Risk Assessment for Deployable Risk Triage**
Submitted to **NeurIPS 2026**

- Addressed the deployment risk of neural operators in scientific computing, where incorrect operator predictions can silently corrupt downstream analysis without affordable post-hoc verification.
- Developed a single forward-pass risk assessment module that flags unreliable neural-operator outputs

at inference time for deployable triage.
- Targeted low-overhead safety screening integrable into neural-operator pipelines without expensive ensemble or sampling-based uncertainty estimation.

## Awards

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- National 2nd Prize, Global Campus AI Algorithm Elite Competition (2025)
- National 3rd Prize, Embedded Chip & System Design Competition, FPGA track (2025)

## Skills

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**Programming:** Python, PyTorch, Git, Linux, Hugging Face, LaTeX, experiment tracking, LLM/agent prototyping.
**Mathematics:** Linear Algebra, Probability, Optimization, Signal Processing, Mathematical Modeling.
**Language:** English — CET-6: 519.